

SwipeScreen

Instruction Manual

SwipeScreen is a browser-based app for screening articles during a systematic review. It turns title and abstract screening into fast, swipe-style decisions, calculates inter-reviewer agreement, and exports reconciled, PRISMA-ready results.

Everything runs in your browser. Your search results, decisions, and exports are stored locally (IndexedDB) on your own device. Nothing is uploaded to a server, and there are no accounts to create.

The screening pipeline

SwipeScreen is organized as a three-stage pipeline, shown as three numbered cards on the home screen:

- **1. Title Screening** — screen records by title (fast, swipe-based decisions).
- **2. Synthesis** — combine several reviewers' title-screening exports, measure agreement, and resolve conflicts into a single reconciled list.
- **3. Abstract Screening** — screen articles by reading the full abstract.

A typical two-reviewer review runs straight down the pipeline: each reviewer does Title Screening independently, their exports are combined in Synthesis, and the reconciled list feeds Abstract Screening.

You do **not** have to use every stage. In particular, Abstract Screening can be started on its own over a complete article list (see *Abstract Screening* → *Starting from a full, un-reconciled list*).

Getting started

Run the app

```
npm install
npm run dev
```

Then open the local URL that Vite prints (the app is served under the `/SwipeScreen/` path). A production build is produced with `npm run build`.

Uploading search results

Every new screening project starts by uploading a CSV of records. SwipeScreen recognizes common database exports and auto-maps their columns:

- PubMed
- Scopus
- Web of Science
- EMBASE
- Cochrane

If the format isn't recognized, columns are matched by header name, and you can always adjust the mapping by hand on the **Map Columns** step. Only **Title** is strictly required. For Abstract Screening you will also want **Abstract** mapped so each card has something to read. Files may be .csv or .txt. Records are imported in a randomized order to reduce ordering bias during screening.

Stage 1 — Title Screening

Create a project from the **Title Screening** → **+ New** button, enter a project name and your reviewer name/initials, upload your CSV, confirm the column mapping, and start.

Each record appears as a swipeable card showing the title and basic metadata (authors, year, journal, and links to DOI / PubMed where available).

Action	Swipe	Keys	Meaning
Yes	Right	→ or K	Include
No	Left	← or J	Exclude
Maybe	Up	↑ or M	Undecided / borderline

Other shortcuts: **Ctrl+Z** undo the last decision, **?** show/hide the shortcut help, **Esc** return home. You can also use the on-screen **No / Maybe / Yes** buttons.

Progress is saved continuously. Use **Save** on the screening screen (or **Save Progress (JSON)** on the results screen) to download a resumable snapshot, and **Resume** on the home screen to reload it later.

When every card is decided you land on the **Results** screen. Export the decisions as a CSV — this per-reviewer CSV is exactly what the Synthesis stage expects.

Stage 2 — Synthesis

Synthesis combines the title-screening exports of two or more reviewers.

- 1 Open **Synthesis** → **Start Synthesis**.
- 2 Add each reviewer's exported CSV (at least two).

- 3 SwipeScreen matches records across reviewers — exactly by DOI/title, with fuzzy title matches offered for your approval — and reports agreement: **Cohen's kappa** and **PABAK** for two reviewers, **Fleiss' kappa** for three or more. Agreement statistics are computed only over records matched across all reviewers.
- 4 Resolve any conflicts (records the reviewers decided differently).

The output of Synthesis is a **reconciled CSV**: one row per article carrying a `final_decision` column with values such as `include`, `maybe`, or `exclude`. That reconciled file is the classic input to Abstract Screening.

Stage 3 — Abstract Screening

Abstract Screening is where you read each abstract in full and make an include / maybe / exclude decision. Create a project from **Abstract Screening** → **+ New**. In addition to the project name and reviewer, you can enter:

- **Inclusion criteria** and **Exclusion criteria** — shown in a collapsible “Criteria” banner while you screen, so your rules stay in front of you.
- **Exclusion reasons** — a quick-select list. When you exclude an article you can tag it with a reason (e.g. *Wrong Population*, *Wrong Study Design*), which feeds the exclusion breakdown and the PRISMA counts.

The abstract card is scrollable (rather than flick-to-swipe), so long abstracts are easy to read, and you decide with the **No / Maybe / Yes** buttons or the keyboard shortcuts. Excluding an article opens the exclusion-reason picker; press the number keys **1–9** to pick a reason quickly, or skip it.

What Abstract Screening accepts as input

Abstract Screening works from a CSV, and it now supports **two** kinds of input.

1. A reconciled CSV (from Synthesis). If the CSV has a decision column — `final_decision` or `screening_decision` — SwipeScreen treats it as the output of a prior stage and loads **only the rows marked include or maybe**. Rows marked `exclude` (or anything else) are skipped. This is the standard “second pass on the survivors” workflow and is unchanged.

2. A full, un-reconciled list (no decision column). If the CSV has **no** `final_decision` and **no** `screening_decision` column, there is nothing to filter on — the list was never reconciled. In that case SwipeScreen screens **every row in the file**. This lets you run a single combined screening pass over an entire list from the start, without first going through Title Screening and Synthesis. Just upload a plain CSV (with **Title** and **Abstract** mapped) on the Abstract Screening path and start — every record becomes a card.

Tip. The deciding factor is only whether a decision column is present. A file with a `final_decision` / `screening_decision` column is always filtered to include / maybe; a file without one is always screened in full. If you have a reconciled file but want to re-screen every row, remove the decision column before uploading.

The “nothing to screen” message

You will only ever see this blocking message:

This CSV has a `final_decision` (or `screening_decision`) column, but no rows are marked include or maybe, so there is nothing to screen. Fix the decision values, or remove the column to screen every row in the file.

in the one genuine case where the CSV **does** have a decision column but **none** of its rows are include or maybe (for example, every row is exclude). It does **not** appear for a valid file that simply has no decision column — that file is screened in full.

Results and export

When a project is complete (or any time you open its Results screen) you get:

- **Decision counts** — Included, Maybe, and Excluded.
- **Exclusion reasons** — a ranked breakdown of the reasons you tagged.
- **Time stats** — total, average, and median time per card, plus the screening date range.

Two exports are available:

- **Download CSV** — your original columns plus screening columns: `screening_decision`, `exclusion_reason`, `reviewer`, `screening_phase`, `screening_timestamp`, and `time_on_card_seconds`. This is the file you feed into Synthesis (from Title Screening) or archive as your final record.
- **Save Progress (JSON)** — a full, resumable snapshot of the project, articles, and decisions. Reload it later with **Resume** on the home screen.

The tagged decisions and exclusion reasons map directly onto **PRISMA** flow counts (records screened, records excluded with reasons, and studies included; “maybe” is counted with the included group for a conservative screen).

Privacy and data

- All data stays in your browser's local IndexedDB storage.
- No account, no server, no upload.

- Because storage is local to one browser profile on one device, use **Save Progress (JSON)** to back up or move a project between machines, and keep your exported CSVs as the durable record.

Quick reference

I want to...	Do this
Screen titles fast	Title Screening → + New → upload CSV → swipe
Combine two reviewers & measure kappa	Synthesis → add both exported CSVs
Second-pass the survivors by abstract	Abstract Screening → + New → upload the reconciled CSV
Screen a whole list by abstract from scratch	Abstract Screening → + New → upload a plain CSV with no decision column
Resume an interrupted project	Home → Resume → choose the saved JSON
Get a PRISMA-ready record	Results → Download CSV